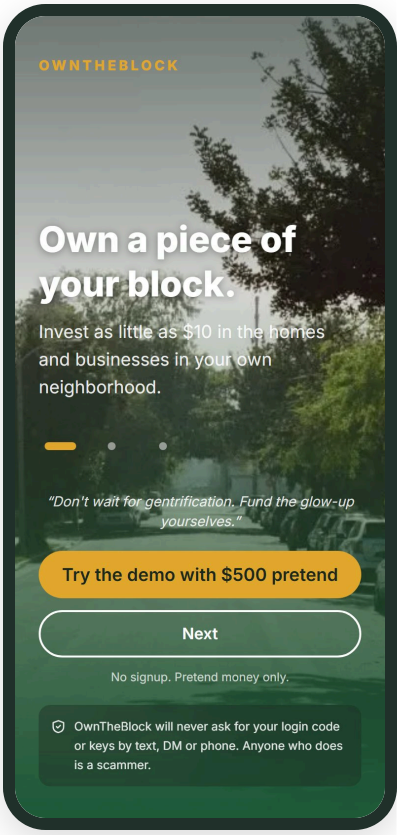
OWNTHEBLOCK

Demo Guide & Video Walkthrough

“Don’t wait for gentrification. Fund the glow-up yourselves.”

Everything the OwnTheBlock app does, screen by screen, with the real numbers it shows, a suggested video script and a recording checklist.

OwnTheBlock is a phone app that lets people in historically underserved neighborhoods **own the homes and businesses on their own block**, starting at **$10**. Neighbors pool money to buy and fix up houses and fund local businesses, then share the rent and revenue. Every dollar can be traced, and built-in lessons teach investing along the way.



Important for your video: this is a working **demo**. It runs on **pretend money** and **fictional properties**. The blockchain steps are **simulated** and formatted like real ones. Connecting real transactions on Base’s free test network is the next build milestone. Photos are openly licensed stand-ins, not Greensboro listings.

Pilot: Greensboro, NC, around NC A&T and Bennett College · Prepared October 2026 · App runs at http://localhost:3000 until it’s deployed

OVERVIEW

What's in this guide

1. The problem and the idea
2. What's real vs. simulated
3. How the app is organized
4. The demo projects and timeline
5. Welcome screen
6. Home tab and the demo clock
7. Explore tab and the Pitch Board
8. Project pages
9. The invest flow
10. Me tab: wallet and portfolio
11. Money Trail
12. Community Impact
13. Block Simulator (My block)
14. Grow the app (economics at scale)
15. Learn tab
16. Honesty and safety rules · Video script · Checklist · Cheat sheet

1. The problem and the idea

The problem

- Real estate is how most American families build wealth, yet roughly **45% of Black households own homes vs. about 74% of white households**.
- Neighborhoods around HBCUs are increasingly bought by outside investors. Rents rise and the value leaves with the rent check.
- Down payments, credit history, accredited-investor rules and little investing education keep residents out.
- Local Black-owned businesses struggle to get fair capital and turn to predatory loans.

The idea

- **Homes:** each rental home sits in its own LLC. Ownership is split into $10 tokens; holders earn monthly rent.
- **Local businesses:** revenue-share deals. Investors get a % of monthly sales until repaid a capped amount (like 1.4×). The owner keeps 100% ownership.
- **Neighborhood Fund:** one token spread across every project, for diversification.
- Residents propose projects and vote; smart contracts handle ownership, payouts and rules.

2. What's real vs. simulated

Works in the demo today	Simulated / not built yet
Full app on a phone: 5 tabs, real photos, installable like an app	No real money moves. Test dollars are pretend
Investing, escrow, refunds, payouts, claims, all following the real rules and formulas	Blockchain transactions are simulated (realistic block numbers and hashes, but not on a real chain)
Demo clock that runs the neighborhood forward month by month	No sign-up, ID check or Face ID yet (the confirm button stands in for it)
Block Simulator and the 10-year "Grow the app" economic model	Properties, people and addresses are fictional; photos are stand-ins
Lessons with quizzes, Money Trail, Community Impact	Next milestones: smart contracts on Base Sepolia, smart wallets, real test transactions

> SAY IT LIKE THIS
>
> *"This is a working demo with pretend money. Every rule and formula is real, and it's built to run on Base's test network next."*

THE MAP

3. How the app is organized

Every screen has a yellow banner: *"Demo using test money. No real dollars are invested."* Five tabs sit along the bottom:

Tab	What it's for
Home	Your balance, test dollars, the demo clock, what's raising now, your holdings, activity and neighborhood snapshot
Explore	Map, project cards with photos, filters and the Community Pitch Board (with voting)
Simulate (center)	Two simulators: **My block** (watch $10 work on one block) and **Grow the app** (10-year economics at scale)
Learn	"Level Up": 2-minute lessons with quick quizzes and badges
Me	Wallet, claiming payouts, portfolio charts, holdings, Money Trail, rent-to-own, reset demo

4. The demo projects and timeline

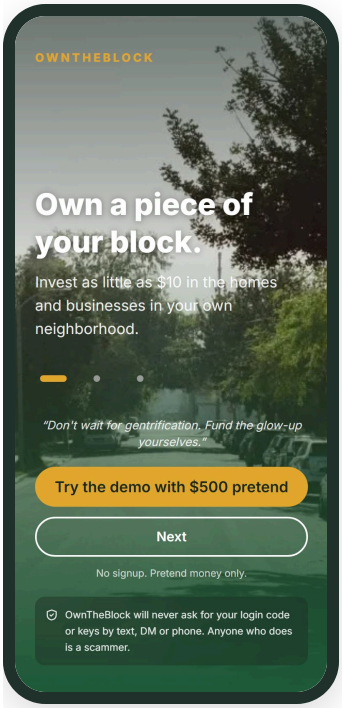
All projects are fictional. The demo clock starts in **November 2026**.

Project	Type	At the start	What happens over time
1204 Sample St	3-bed bungalow	Operating, fully funded ($150,000)	Can't buy in (resale opens 12 months after a raise). Empty spell Apr–May 2027, roof repair Feb 2028
Corner Cuts Barbershop	Revenue share: 5% of sales until repaid 1.4×	Operating, fully funded ($25,000)	Keeps repaying with seasonal ups and downs
88 Example Ave	Two-unit house	**Raising:** $96,000 of $150,000, closes in 3 months	Usually completes Jan 2027 → renovation → family moves in Apr 2027 → first payout May 2027. Water heater Oct 2027, empty month Apr 2028
Greensboro Neighborhood Fund	Spreads money across every project	**Always open**	Pays from month 1
Spin City Laundromat	Revenue share: 7% until 1.5×	Community vote	Raise opens Dec 2026
310 Demo Ct	Boarded-up house	Under review	Raise opens Jan 2027
Aggie Corner Market	Fresh-food corner store	Proposed	Raise opens Mar 2027
42 Placeholder Ln	Brick bungalow	Proposed	Raise opens May 2027

Each month on the demo clock, neighbors keep investing (about **$40,000** in the first month, growing **4% a month**). Raises complete or refund automatically, new raises open, and payouts arrive using the spec's formulas. You only see a property's repairs and vacancies if you own part of it.

SCREENS

5. Welcome screen

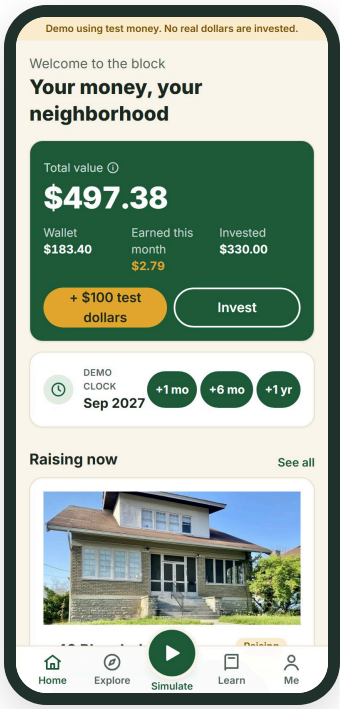


- Three slides, each over a full-screen neighborhood photo: **"Own a piece of your block."** · **"Watch your money work."** · **"Learn as you earn."**
- **Try the demo with $500 pretend** goes to Home. **Next** moves through the slides; on the last one it becomes **Watch the Block Simulator**.
- No signup. A scam warning sits at the bottom: *"OwnTheBlock will never ask for your login code or keys by text, DM or phone."*
- Installs on a phone like a real app (Share → Add to Home Screen).

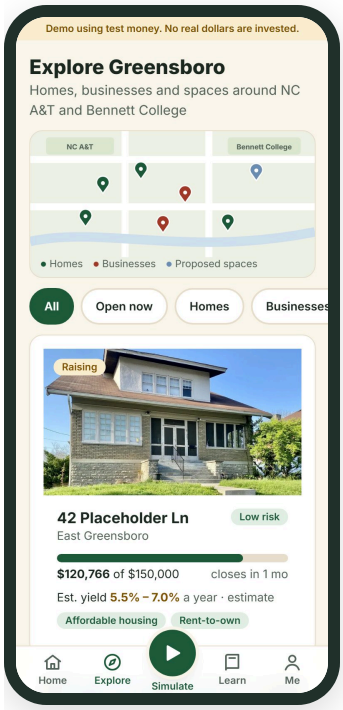
> **SAY**
> *"Walk two blocks from A&T and count how many homes are owned by people who live there. OwnTheBlock lets the neighborhood buy its own block, starting at ten dollars."*

6. Home tab and the demo clock

- **Total value card:** Total value, Wallet, Earned this month, Invested. Tap the ⓘ for "What is USDC?" (a digital dollar always worth $1).
- **+ $100 test dollars**: pretend money, up to **$500 a day**, like a test-network faucet. **Invest** jumps to Explore.
- **Demo clock** (the star of the demo): **+1 mo · +6 mo · +1 yr**. Skipping ahead runs the whole neighborhood forward, then a pop-up titled *"Now it's [month]"* lists what happened to your money.
- **Raising now:** the current open raise with its photo, progress bar and "refunded automatically if it misses."
- **Your holdings:** photo, tokens, value and earnings for each investment.
- **Activity:** every transaction. Tap one for a plain-English explanation, from/to addresses, block number, transaction hash, "Fee $0.00 (OwnTheBlock paid the gas)" and whether it's on-chain or off-chain.
- **Your neighborhood:** residents who are owners, homes owned by the block and dollars kept local. Opens the Impact page.



7. Explore tab and the Community Pitch Board

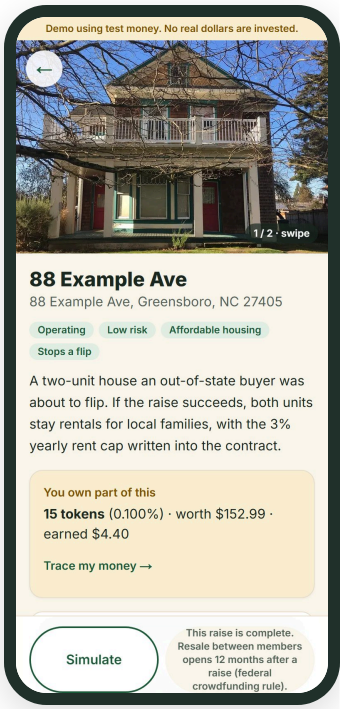


- **Map** of Greensboro with pins near NC A&T and Bennett College. Green = homes, red = businesses, blue = proposed spaces.
- **Filters:** All · Open now · Homes · Businesses · Fund. Open raises are listed first.
- **Project cards:** a real photo, stage badge (Raising, Renovating, Operating…), risk level, raise progress, estimated yield range (labeled "estimate") and impact tags such as "Affordable housing" and "Black-owned business."
- **Community Pitch Board:** projects neighbors proposed, with a progress bar: Proposed → Under review → Community vote → Raising → Renovating → Operating.
- **Voting:** Spin City Laundromat starts in "Community vote." Tap **Yes** or **No**; verified residents' votes count 1.5×. Voting is only open at the very start (Nov 2026), so **film it before skipping ahead**.

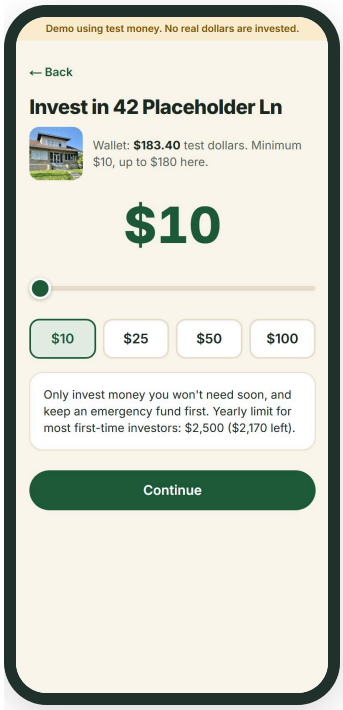
> **SAY**
>
> *"Neighbors don't just invest. They propose the projects and vote on what gets funded, and residents' votes count more."*

8. Project pages

- **Swipeable photo gallery** (homes include a "Renovation stage" photo) and the project's story.
- **"You own part of this"**: your tokens, ownership %, value, earnings and **Trace my money**.
- **Raise status** in plain English, e.g. "Closes [month]. If the goal isn't met, every investor is refunded automatically."
- **The numbers (homes):** for 1204 Sample St, $1,400 rent − vacancy buffer $70 − management $112 − repair reserve $140 − platform fee $28 − taxes + insurance $200 = **$850 a month to token holders**, about **$0.06 per $10 token**, a **6.8% yearly yield**. 88 Example Ave: $1,450 rent → $887.50 a month, about 7.1%.
- **The numbers (businesses):** revenue share %, repayment cap, about **42 months** to pay back (about 56 if sales drop 25%), and **"Owner keeps 100% ownership."**
- **History:** chart plus monthly income statements: 18 months for Sample St (with a vacancy, roof repair and a 3% rent-increase vote) and 22 for Corner Cuts.
- Risks, documents, photo credits and bottom buttons: **Simulate** and **Invest from $10** (or the reason you can't yet).



9. The invest flow



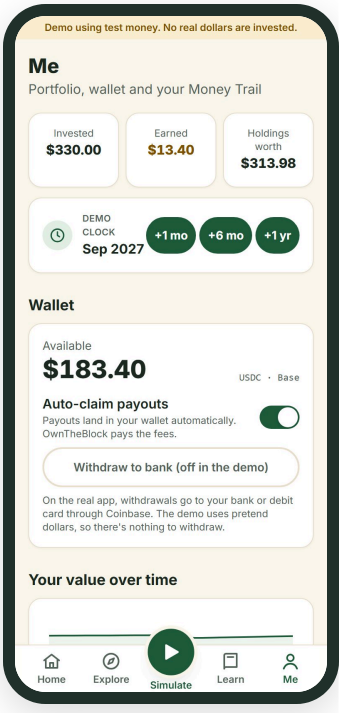
1. **Amount:** slider or quick buttons ($10 / $25 / $50 / $100). Shows your wallet, room left in the raise and your **$2,500 yearly limit** (a federal crowdfunding rule).
2. **Review:** you pay · tokens you get · **% of the property you'll own** · fees to you **$0.00** (the project pays the 3% raise fee; gas is sponsored) · ongoing 2% fee · **can't sell for 12 months**. A first investment over $100 shows a **24-hour cooling-off** notice.
3. **"What happens when you confirm":** four plain-English steps: escrow → goal → tokens → recorded on the blockchain.
4. **Confirm:** a big button standing in for Face ID or fingerprint.
5. **Done:** a gold coin flies into the property photo: "You own a piece of the block!" It shows the block number and transaction hash, plus **Skip ahead on the demo clock** and **Trace my money**.

Rules enforced: $10 minimum · enough in your wallet · room left in the raise · yearly limit · no buying into finished raises · automatic refunds if a raise misses its deadline.

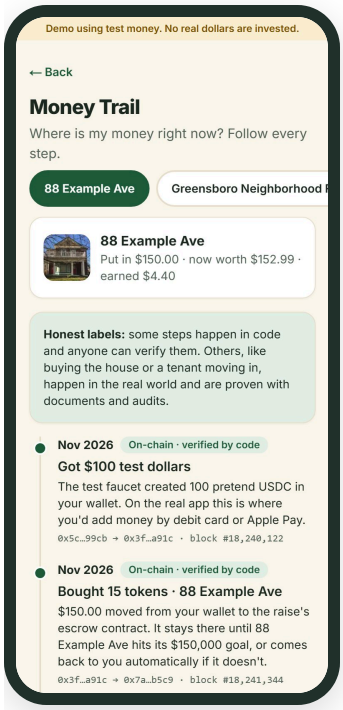
> **SAY**
>
> *"Ten dollars, no fees to me, and it tells me exactly what I own: point-one percent of a real house."*

10. Me tab: wallet and portfolio

- **Summary:** Invested · Earned · Holdings worth, plus the demo clock.
- **Wallet:** available balance; **Claim** payouts (when auto-claim is off); **Auto-claim** toggle; **Withdraw to bank** is off in the demo, with an explanation.
- **Your value over time** chart and **Where your money is** donut (homes, businesses, fund).
- **Holdings** with ownership % and **Trace my money**; **All activity**.
- **Rent-to-own (a tenant's view):** tenants earn tokens worth 2% of each on-time rent payment. Example: **39.2 tokens worth $392 after 14 payments**, toward a $7,500 down payment.
- **More:** Community impact · Grow the app · Block Simulator · Photo credits · **Reset demo**.
- Your pretend wallet is saved on the phone, so it's still there when you reopen the app.



11. Money Trail: “Where is my money right now?”

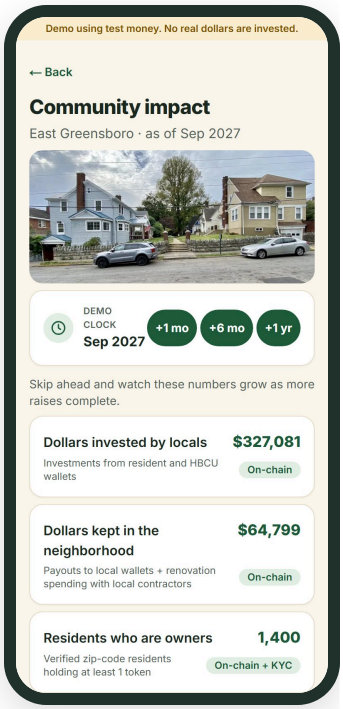


- A step-by-step timeline for each investment, oldest first. Switch between projects with the chips at the top.
- Two honest labels:
  - **On-chain · verified by code** test dollars, buying tokens, raise released to the LLC.
  - **Off-chain · verified by documents** the LLC buying the house, a tenant moving in.
- Each step shows what happened, from → to addresses and the block number.
- Monthly payouts show up in Activity rather than in the trail.

> **SAY**
>
> *“A blockchain can’t prove a house exists or that a tenant paid rent. So the app is honest: code proves what code can prove, and documents prove the rest.”*

12. Community Impact

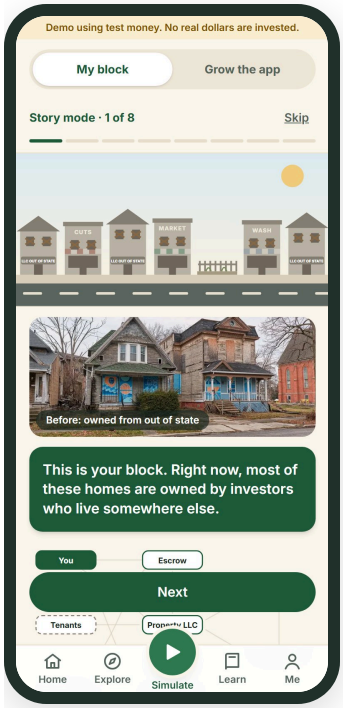
- Eight neighborhood metrics that **grow as you skip ahead** on the demo clock:
  - Dollars invested by locals
  - Dollars kept in the neighborhood
  - Residents who are owners
  - Homes owned by the community
  - Average rent vs. market (86%)
  - Local jobs supported
  - Businesses funded (no predatory loans)
  - Tenant ownership through rent-to-own
- Each metric says where its data comes from: **On-chain**, **On-chain + KYC** or **Admin data**.
- Shares like “40% of investors live in the zip code” are labeled as assumptions.



SIMULATE TAB

13. Block Simulator (“My block”)

A separate sandbox with pretend numbers, not tied to your demo wallet. The toggle at the top switches between **My block** and **Grow the app**.



Story mode, step 1

Story mode (opens the first time; tap ▶ Story to replay)

1. “This is your block. Most homes are owned by investors who live somewhere else.”
2. You add $10. It becomes 10 digital dollars (USDC).
3. You buy 1 token of 1204 Sample St. Your $10 goes into escrow.
4. About 500 neighbors and alumni join in, averaging $300 each. The $150,000 goal is reached.
5. A family rents the home for $1,400 a month.
6. Bills get paid first, and 10% goes to a repair reserve.
7. What’s left ($850) is split among all token holders: about 6 cents for you this month.
8. Every step is on the blockchain. Tap any block to check it.

The photo changes from a **run-down “before” house, to a renovation, to the finished bungalow**. Coins move through the money-flow diagram and blocks appear in the ledger. It ends with **“Ready? Start with $10.”**

The sandbox

- **Illustrated street of 7 buildings.** They go from boarded up, to scaffolding, to fresh paint with lights on and people outside, with “FOR RENT,” “SOLD,” “CLOSED” and “PAID ✓” tags. Tap a building to see its photo and stats.
- **Money-flow diagram:** gold coins move between You, Escrow, Property LLC, Tenants, Expenses, Reserve, Distributor and Investors. Solid boxes = on-chain; dashed = real world.
- **Blockchain ledger:** a scrolling chain of blocks. Gold borders = your wallet. Tap one for its explanation.
- **My results:** Invested, Earned, Current value, Total return, with a chart. **Tap any number to see its formula** with live values.
- **Neighborhood impact meters** and a **player bar**: play/pause, a 10-year scrubber, 1×/4× speed.



Sandbox at year 2½

13. Block Simulator, continued

Try it your way

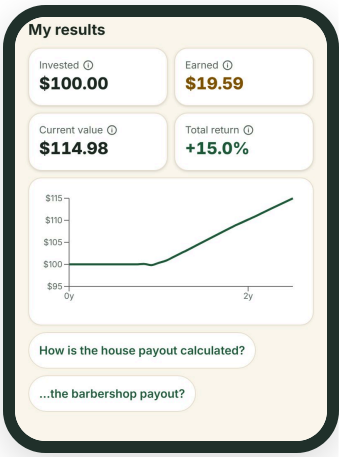
- Your investment: **$10 to $1,000**.
- Where it goes: **Safe / Balanced / Growth** presets, or your own split between homes, businesses and the Neighborhood Fund.
- **Neighbors investing: 10 to 5,000**. More neighbors fund more buildings, faster. With 10 neighbors the raise fails and you're refunded automatically.
- **Reinvest my earnings** (compounding), **Random life events**, and **Compare with savings and cash** (with an editable savings rate).
- **Assumptions:** home value growth, monthly neighbor contributions, inflation.

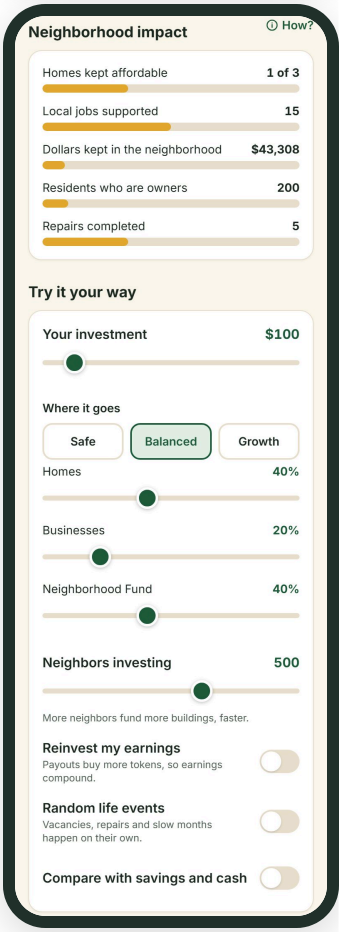
What if… buttons

Event	What you'll see
Tenant moves out	2 months of no rent and no payout; the reserve pays the bills
Roof repair	$6,000 from the reserve; payouts refill it if it runs short
Rent increase vote passes	+3%. A second one within 12 months is **blocked** by the contract rules
Barbershop's best month	+40% sales, bigger payout
Slow winter	Sales down 25% for 3 months, longer payback
Sell the house	Tokens turn into cash: appreciation minus selling costs, plus the reserve
Business closes	A real loss, softened by a first-loss partner and the Fund's diversification

Share this scenario copies a link with your exact settings. Handy links: `/simulate?month=36` jumps to year 3; `/simulate?amount=10&focus=homes` starts with $10 in a house.

> **SAY**
>
> *"Watch what happens when the roof goes, or the barbershop closes. The app shows losses as clearly as gains."*

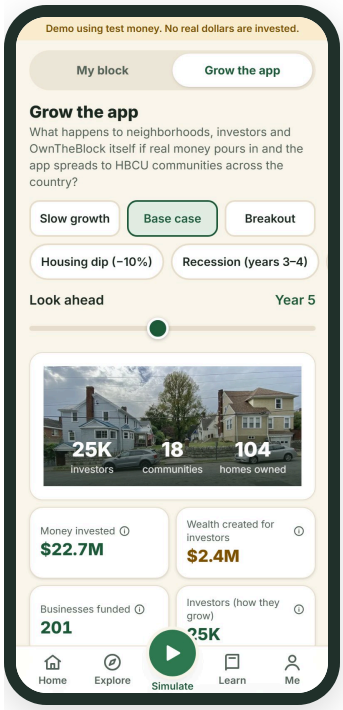




SIMULATE TAB

14. Grow the app: the economics at scale

The question it answers: *"What happens if real money pours in and this spreads to HBCU communities across the country?"*



Controls

- **Scenarios:** Slow growth · Base case · Breakout.
- **Stress tests:** Housing dip (−10%) · Recession (years 3–4: more vacancies, double business failures, slower sign-ups).
- **Fee test:** +1% yearly asset fee.
- **Look ahead:** year slider from 1 to 10. **Change assumptions** opens nine sliders (sign-ups, expansion pace, contributions, churn, home share, appreciation, business failures, homes per neighborhood, company costs).

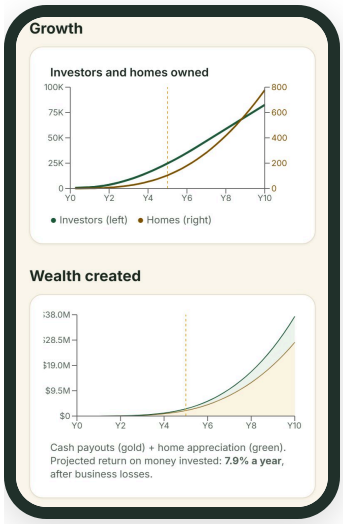
What it shows

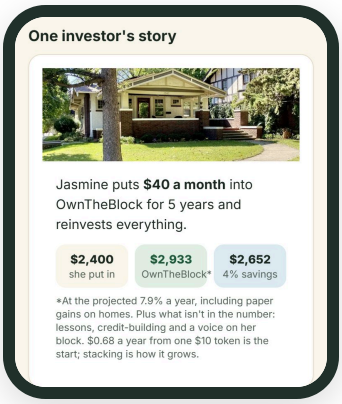
- Investors, communities and homes owned, over a neighborhood photo.
- Eight tiles, each with "How is this calculated?": money invested, wealth created, businesses funded, investors, tenant savings + equity, local jobs, dollars kept local, homes.
- Charts: growth, wealth created, one investor's story, whether OwnTheBlock can pay its own bills, and what limits growth.

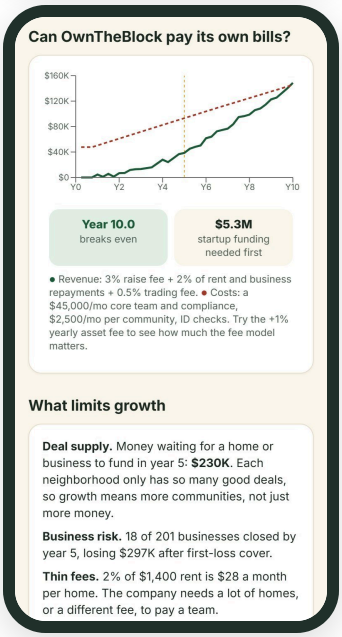
Base-case results

	Year 5	Year 10
Investors	~25,000	~82,500
Communities	18	38
Homes owned by communities	~104	~777
Businesses funded	~200	~1,070
Money invested	~$23M	~$168M
Wealth created for investors	~$2.4M	~$35M

14. Grow the app, continued







For investors

Projected return: **about 8% a year** after business losses (cash payouts plus home appreciation on paper).

One investor's story: Jasmine puts $40 a month in for 5 years and reinvests. She puts in **$2,400**, which grows to about **$2,930**, versus about **$2,650** in a 4% savings account.

For OwnTheBlock the company

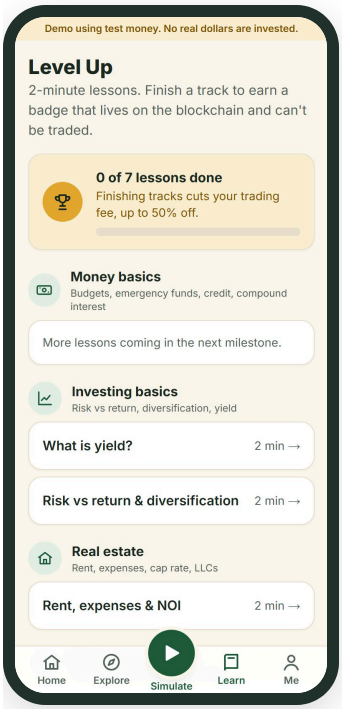
Scenario	Breaks even	Startup $ needed
Slow growth	Not in 10 years	~$7.4M
Base case	~Year 10	~$5.3M
Breakout	~Year 6	~$2.6M

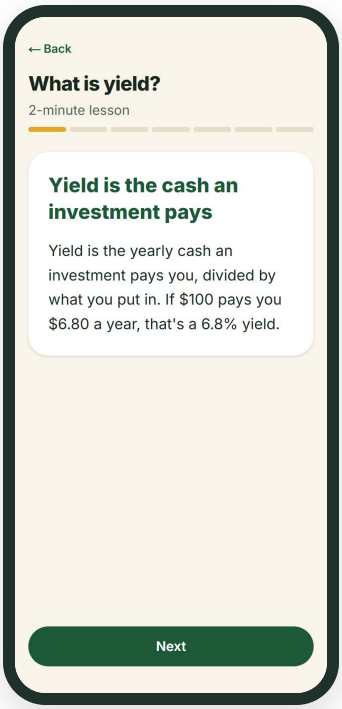
The honest takeaways

- **Thin fees:** 2% of $1,400 rent is $28 a month per home. Try the +1% asset fee: break-even comes much sooner, but it's paid out of investors' returns. The fee model is the biggest open decision.
- **Deal supply:** each neighborhood only has so many good homes. Growth means launching new communities, not just raising more money.
- **Business risk:** some businesses close. The model shows the losses after first-loss cover.

> **SAY**
>
> *"At scale, this keeps hundreds of homes affordable and creates thousands of local jobs. We also found the hard part: our fees are thin, so we're testing the business model now."*

15. Learn tab: “Level Up”





- **7 two-minute lessons** across 6 tracks:
  - What is a blockchain?
  - What is USDC?
  - What is yield?
  - Risk vs return & diversification
  - Rent, expenses & NOI
  - How revenue share works
  - How to spot a scam

  Money basics says “more lessons coming.”
- Each lesson: 3–4 swipe cards, then a **3-question check** that explains right and wrong answers, then a trophy.
- Progress is saved. Finishing a track earns a badge, designed to live on the blockchain and lower trading fees.
- Lessons never pay cash rewards (keeps it compliant).

16. Honesty and safety rules

Built-in protections

- “Estimates, not guarantees. You can lose some or all of your investment” on every project and simulator.
- Federal crowdfunding yearly limit ($2,500 in the demo) and 12-month resale lockup.
- 3% yearly rent cap; a second increase within a year is blocked.
- Automatic refunds if a raise misses its goal.
- 24-hour cooling-off on a first investment over $100.

Trust and safety

- No seed phrase, no crypto knowledge, no gas fees (sponsored).
- Anti-scam warnings and a scam lesson.
- Every number traces back to a formula (“How is this calculated?”).
- On-chain vs. off-chain steps clearly labeled.
- Photos credited on the in-app Photo credits page.

MAKE THE VIDEO

17. Suggested video: 5–7 minutes

Time	Show	Say
0:00	Welcome slides	The problem (the homeownership gap, outside investors buying near HBCUs) and the tagline.
0:30	Simulate → Story mode	"Watch ten dollars become ownership of a real house." Tap through all 8 steps.
1:30	Explore → Pitch Board → vote Yes on the laundromat	"Neighbors decide what gets funded, and residents' votes count more."
2:00	Home → + $100 ×5 → invest in 88 Example Ave and the Fund	Show the Review screen: ownership %, $0 fees, the 12-month lockup.
3:00	Demo clock **+6 mo** → the pop-up	"The raise completed, the house was renovated, a family moved in, and I got paid."
3:45	Me → Trace my money	"On-chain steps are verified by code; real-world steps by documents."
4:15	Simulate → My block → Roof repair, Business closes	"It shows losses as clearly as gains."
4:45	Grow the app → Base → Breakout → Recession	Impact at scale, and the honest finding about fees and break-even.
5:45	Impact page, then Learn	Community impact and the education angle: "Learn as you earn."
6:15	Close on Home	"Next: real transactions on Base's test network, then a licensed crowdfunding partner for real money."

Recording checklist

1. **Me** → **Reset demo** for a clean start (wallet $0, clock Nov 2026).
2. Record your phone screen, or use your browser's phone view (F12 → device toolbar).
3. Vote on the laundromat **before** skipping ahead.
4. To show payouts fast: invest in **88 Example Ave + the Fund**, then **+6 mo**. The Fund pays from month 1, and the house starts paying in May 2027.
5. Tap one Activity item to show the block number, hash and $0.00 fee.
6. The first visit to Simulate opens Story mode; use ▶ **Story** to replay it.

Words to use, and to avoid

Say: "working demo," "pretend money," "simulated blockchain steps," "built to run on Base's test network next," "estimates, not guarantees."

Avoid: "real money," "live on the blockchain," "guaranteed returns," or naming the photos as real Greensboro properties.

Likely judge questions

- **"Isn't $0.68 a year too small?"** It's the start. Show Jasmine's $40 a month in Grow the app.
- **"Is this legal?"** Reg CF through a registered funding portal, an LLC per property, ID checks, 12-month lockup.
- **"Why blockchain?"** Thousands of tiny owners, automatic payouts, public proof of every dollar, rules nobody can quietly change.

REFERENCE

18. Numbers cheat sheet

One house (1204 Sample St)

Raise / token price / tokens	$150,000 / $10 / 15,000
Purchase + renovation + reserve	$132,000 + $15,000 + $3,000
Monthly rent	$1,400
To token holders	**$850 a month**
Per $10 token	~$0.06 a month, ~$0.68 a year
Cash yield	**6.8% a year**
Sale at year 7 (3% growth)	~$11.53 per token + ~$4.76 rent ≈ $16.29 per $10

One business (Corner Cuts)

Raise	$25,000 (2,500 tokens)
Revenue share	5% of monthly sales
Cap	1.4× = $35,000
Monthly payment	~$833 (on $200,000/yr sales)
Payback	~42 months (~56 if sales −25%)
Per token	~$0.33 a month until $14 repaid
Owner keeps	100% ownership

Tenants

Rent-to-own	2% of rent in tokens = 2.8 tokens a month
Per year	~$336 of ownership
Rent cap	3% a year max
Rent vs. market	86% (demo assumption)

Fees and rules

Raise fee (paid by project)	3%
Ongoing platform fee	2% of rent or revenue
Trading fee	0.5% (resales after 12 months)
Test dollars	$100 per tap, $500 a day
Yearly investment limit	$2,500 (demo)

What comes next

1. **Deploy** to a free public link (Vercel) so anyone can open it on their phone.
2. **Smart contracts** on Base Sepolia (Base's free test network): escrow, payouts, governance, rules.
3. **Smart wallets** with Face ID login, sponsored gas and a real test-USDC faucet. The demo's buttons switch from pretend to real test transactions.
4. **Real money** later, only through a registered Reg CF funding portal partner, with lawyers.

All projects, people, addresses and numbers in the demo are fictional. Photos are openly licensed (CC0, CC BY, CC BY-SA via Openverse) and credited in the app under Me → Photo credits. Projections are estimates, not promises.